



TEN YEARS AGO, *Yeh Rishta Kya Kehlata Hai* used to garner TRPs of 9-10. Now, it's a big [achievement] even if you touch 2-3," says Hindi and Marathi TV serial producer Rajan Shahi, who is known for the show that has been airing on Star Plus since 2009, as well as hits like *Anupamaa* (Hindi, 2020) and *Aai Kuthe Kay Karte* (Marathi, 2019).

His contemporary, Saurabh Tewari, writer and producer of Hindi shows like *Sherdil Shergill* on Colors TV and *Lakhan Leela Bhargav* (LLB) on JioCinema, points

out that *Anupamaa* used to get urban TRP, or target rating points, of 4+ in 2020 when it was launched. "Now, it is at 2.8 even though it continues to be the top show. The volume of consumption (on TV) has come down." TRP is a metric used by marketing and advertising agencies to evaluate viewership.

At their peak, before the binge-watching era, primetime TV serials had audiences in a spell for years on end, even if the plot barely moved. But OTT (over the top) content and its convenience of non-linear viewing, digital short videos, and social media are pulling audience attention in different directions. And the ratings of TV serials—the backbone of general entertainment channels (GECs)—are plunging. Some producers, at least in the regional language space, are already talking of a big shift in ad spend towards OTT and social media. And the dip in TRPs has forced producers to tweak their format to appeal to audiences across platforms in what is being dubbed the 'TV+' model.

Things are especially bleak for the Hindi TV serial industry—the largest among Indian languages—as the success rate and shelf lives of shows are shrinking. Eight years ago, 80 per cent of shows used to complete a year, say producers. Several,

THEN AND NOW



Among Hindi TV shows there has been a big decline in the TRP of the highest-rated show

SEPTEMBER 2018

HINDI

Show	TRP (U+R)	TRP (Urban)	Channel
<i>Naagin 3</i>	2.81	4.2	Colors
<i>Yeh Rishta Kya Kehlata Hai</i>	2.4	3.76	Star Plus
<i>Kundali Bhagya</i>	2.53	3.39	Zee TV
<i>Kumkum Bhagya</i>	2.5	3.25	Zee TV

U: URBAN; R: RURAL;

SOURCE: BARC DATA (WEEK 35: AUG 26 TO SEPT 1)

NOTE: HINDI SHOWS SORTED BY URBAN SCORE

TAMIL

Show	TRP (U+R)	Channel
<i>Naayagi</i>	16.19	Sun TV
<i>Nandini</i>	15.93	Sun TV
<i>Azhagu</i>	14.24	Sun TV
<i>Kalyana Veedu</i>	12.32	Sun TV
<i>Yaaradi Nee Mohini</i>	12.29	Zee Tamil

SOURCE: BARC DATA (WEEK 35: AUG 26 TO SEPT 1), VALUES AVERAGE OF TN/PUDUCHERRY (U+R)

TOP-RATED SHOWS IN

TELUGU: *Karthika Deepam*, Star Maa, 15.13

MARATHI: *Mazhya Navryachi Bayko*, Zee Marathi, 8.94

BENGALI: *Krishnakoli*, Zee Bangla, 11.44